

The Boston Globe

Serving our community since 1872

THURSDAY, JUNE 4, 2026



DAVID L. RYAN/GLOBE STAFF

Iowa resident Koleen Starkey, with the American Veterans Archeological Recovery program, sifted dirt on Tuesday.

HISTORY REEMERGES

Digging at Bunker Hill battlefield offers tantalizing clues to what could be a key fort

By Brian MacQuarrie
GLOBE STAFF

Standing atop the Bunker Hill battlefield in Charlestown, Joe Bagley held a small, smooth sliver of flint in his hand, slowly turning it over and over and tracing his finger along its thin, curved edge.

“It’s crazy. This hasn’t seen the light of day for 250 years,” Bagley said quietly. “And it’s witnessed hell. The person who had this with him was in the middle of a living nightmare.”

The archeologist for the city of Boston, Bagley was supervising a rare dig of one of the most important sites in American history that is coinciding with the 250th anniversary of the nation’s founding.

And the gun flint, which was used to create a spark to fire an 18th-century musket, was the first artifact recovered in the new search for the redoubt, or large earthen fort, where American rebels massed against British regulars in the fierce Revolutionary fighting of June 17, 1775. A pair of musket balls also have been discovered.

The redoubt itself has never been exposed despite a few previous digs dating back decades. But now, using improved, state-of-the-art technology that can provide better indications of what lies underground, Bagley believes he and his team know the location of the remnants of the fort, other relics, and perhaps even remains of fallen soldiers.

If excavations over the next two to three weeks prove them right, the center of this iconic battle site will emerge again. It was

BUNKER HILL, Page A7

Workers at bars wary of a later close for Cup

By Celine Hijazi
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

While World Cup fans from around the world are about to descend on Boston this month, many workers in the city’s hospitality industry are approaching the tournament with caution, now that it looks like their shifts could last deeper into the night.

State Representative Carole A. Fiola, a Fall River Democrat, recently proposed legislation to allow cities to authorize bars to remain open until 3 a.m., an hour later than the current 2 a.m. closing time, and also designate public areas where people could consume alcoholic beverages, during the 2026 FIFA World Cup. The proposal, backed by Boston Mayor Michelle Wu, would apply from June 1 through Aug. 31.

In Rhode Island, Governor Daniel J. McKee signed a similar bill last week, allowing bars to remain open until 4 a.m. during the Cup.

BARS, Page A6

With hot dog cameos, MFA tries something a little revolutionary

By Celina Colby
GLOBE CORRESPONDENT

Boston history just got a whole lot meatier.

In a twist of culinary fate, Chelsea hot dog brand Kayem, maker of Fenway Franks, is partnering with the Museum of Fine Arts, Boston to celebrate the nation’s 250th anniversary by updating Revolutionary-era painting using AI to include famous American subjects grilling hot dogs, double-fisting them, and even shooting them out of a cannon.

There’s the signature artwork of George Washington crossing the Delaware, reworked to include a grillmaster in Colonial garb tending to a sizzling serving of hot dogs, while Gilbert Stuart’s Ben



AI IMAGE/KAYEM

The MFA stands behind the playful campaign, but it may get some pushback over the use of artificial intelligence.

Franklin is shown one bite deep into a dog dressed with a ribbon of mustard.

This is the first time the MFA has collaborated with a food brand, and comes at a time when the institution is facing a \$13 million projected deficit, which led to job cuts earlier this year. To see the MFA taking on the playfulness of an influencer is an unexpected turn for an institution born in 1870 from the collection of the Boston Athenaeum’s private library.

On the one hand, the hot dog stunt could be seen as a long-overdue bid to stay relevant. But it may also draw criticism, especially due to the use of AI.

HOT DOGS, Page A10

With eye on rival, Wu backs newcomer

Mayor endorses Gayle in Senate race vs. Collins

By Niki Griswold
GLOBE STAFF

Buoyed by her own resounding reelection victory, Mayor Michelle Wu took direct aim at Beacon Hill on Wednesday, endorsing a political newcomer running for state Senate against her political nemesis in a primary that could test the reach of Wu’s considerable political capital.

In the world of Boston politics, Wu’s endorsement of Latoya Gayle over incumbent Nick Collins of South Boston is a rare, eyebrow-raising move: backing a first-time candidate over a sitting Democrat with a long record of winning elections and one who serves on a body that determines whether many of her legislative proposals live or die.

Wu has fiercely, and publicly, clashed with Collins, primarily over her push to temporarily shift more of the city’s property tax burden onto commercial real estate to ease property tax spikes for homeowners. Collins, who has held his Senate seat since 2018, has routinely stymied her efforts, accusing Wu of “hyperbole and fear-mongering” in pushing a measure that has repeatedly died in his chamber.

Wu on Wednesday said Gayle would be a “powerful, principled voice” in the Senate who “has stood with our families even when state legislators have not.”

SENATE RACE, Page A7

Despite losses, Tufts Medicine shows signs of stabilizing

By Marin Wolf
GLOBE STAFF

Given the state of the health care industry these days, losing less money feels like the new up.

Tufts Medicine reported a loss on operations in the first half of this fiscal year — \$46 million — similar to its results from the previous year. For a beleaguered health system facing climbing health care costs and impending cuts of federal funding, experts said, the result could be read as a measure of stability.

“If you look at the whole health system’s performance, that would suggest that things are more stable,” said Christopher Whaley, associate professor of health services, policy, and practice at the Brown University School of Public Health.

In a state where just a few large institutions provide a majority of the hospital care, the financial well-being of any one of them is crucial at a time when inflation and other cost pressures on providers, insurers, businesses, and consumers

TUFTS, Page A10

The House defied President Trump by approving a war powers resolution that would halt military action against Iran. **A3.**

With Black men in Boston living shorter lives than other men here, city officials and public health leaders launched an effort to close that gap, backed by an infusion of \$1 million. **B1.**

Thanks to cash from an investor, Boston-area chain Clover is preparing to reopen some of its restaurants just days after shutting down all retail operations. **D1.**

Ukrainian long-range drones struck an oil terminal in St. Petersburg, the city where President Vladimir Putin was born. **A4.**

Having a blast

Thursday: Heating up. High 84-89. Low 64-69.

Friday: More of the same. High 85-90. Low 65-70.

Weather and Comics, D5-6.

VOL. 309, NO. 155

Suggested retail price \$4.00



POWER OF A
**GREAT
RATE**

4.00%
APY*
5-, 7-, AND 12-MONTH CD
OR IRA CD SPECIAL

Don’t miss this great rate while it lasts – promotion ending soon!

Other CD terms are available. To open your new CD, visit any Salem Five branch location or visit saalemfive.com/CDpromo

SalemFive
MAKE YOUR MOVE.™

*Annual Percentage Yield (APY) is accurate as of 5/12/26 and subject to change. A minimum balance of \$10,000 is required to open and obtain the annual percentage yield (APY) for our non-IRA CD Special, and for our IRA CD Special the minimum balance is \$2,000. A penalty will be imposed for early withdrawals from Certificates of Deposit (CDs). Maximum deposit amount is \$500,000. Fees may reduce earnings. Personal accounts only. One account per customer. Salem Five Bank is a Member of the FDIC.